community at the apogee of his concerns. For him, business enterprises were ‘corporate citizens’ with the duty to serve the various stakeholders ‘perhaps collectively viewed by him as the community’.

Paying Jamsetji glowing tributes after his death, a leading newspaper described him as one who ‘claimed no privilege, but the advancement of India and her myriad peoples were with him an abiding passion’. To him, wealth was ‘not an end, but a means to an end, the increased prosperity of India’. He believed that wealth was the resource of the society held in trusteeship by those who accumulate it. Moving a resolution on Jamsetji’s death, Sir Lawrence Jenkins, chief justice of Bombay, said that ‘throughout his whole busy career, he was actuated by an earnest desire to do everything in his power to advance the welfare and development of the country in all directions’.

Jamsetji had set the trend when in 1886 he introduced liberal benefits for the workers of Empress Mills, including pension funds. Retrenchment of employees was only a last-resort action even when they became surplus. Notwithstanding this, they were paid a ‘liberal compensation’, although the ‘social obligation for such compensation was hardly recognised’.

Jamsetji’s philanthropic efforts had begun with the creation of an endowment in 1892 for students seeking higher studies, a first in the world. It was aimed at providing funds for those aspiring to compete in the Indian civil service examination as most Indians did not have the ‘financial means’ to ‘appear for competitive examinations, which were then held exclusively in the UK’. Following in the footsteps of the founder, his successors and their relatives pursued the philanthropic goal with passion.

However, Sir Dorabji Tata, the older of the founder’s two sons, was more focussed on implementing his father’s dream of industrializing India. The younger son, Sir Ratan Tata, in contrast, set much store by societal transformation. He focussed on welfare activities, taking forward his father’s philanthropic goals, says his namesake, Ratan.

Sir Ratan was a committed philanthropist, a protagonist of social change and a staunch nationalist and patriot. He contributed liberally to relief activities connected with ‘natural calamities like floods, famines and earthquakes, and for public memorials, schools and hospitals’. In a move that was emblematic of his resolve to promote public health, he donated Rs 10,000 every year for ten years to the King George V Anti-Tuberculosis League, started by the Bombay Municipality. Appreciating the role of